

LANSING'S TOWN BOARD HAS TOLD ITS ATTORNEY TO DRAFT A DATA-CENTER BAN

778 GWh a year goes into the air.

That is the waste heat of Lake Hawkeye's 150 MW first phase. We found the terms under which Lansing can use it.

Thermal Commons Heat for Lansing

The heat is free. The town still might say no.

778 GWh

of heat a year leaves the 150 MW
first phase through dry coolers

No gas

Many homes burn propane and
oil; NYSEG has barred new gas
connections since Feb 2015 (2026
status unverified)

A ban

The Town Board told its attorney
to draft a data-center ban

Lansing, Michigan, 6 April 2026: Deep Green withdrew a heat-reuse data center after local opposition. Free heat was not enough.

OUR ANSWER: THE CONDITIONS UNDER WHICH LANSING CAN SAY YES

Don't ban it. Set the terms.

Binding contracts

Community Benefit Agreement
plus a Heat Supply Agreement
with step-in rights

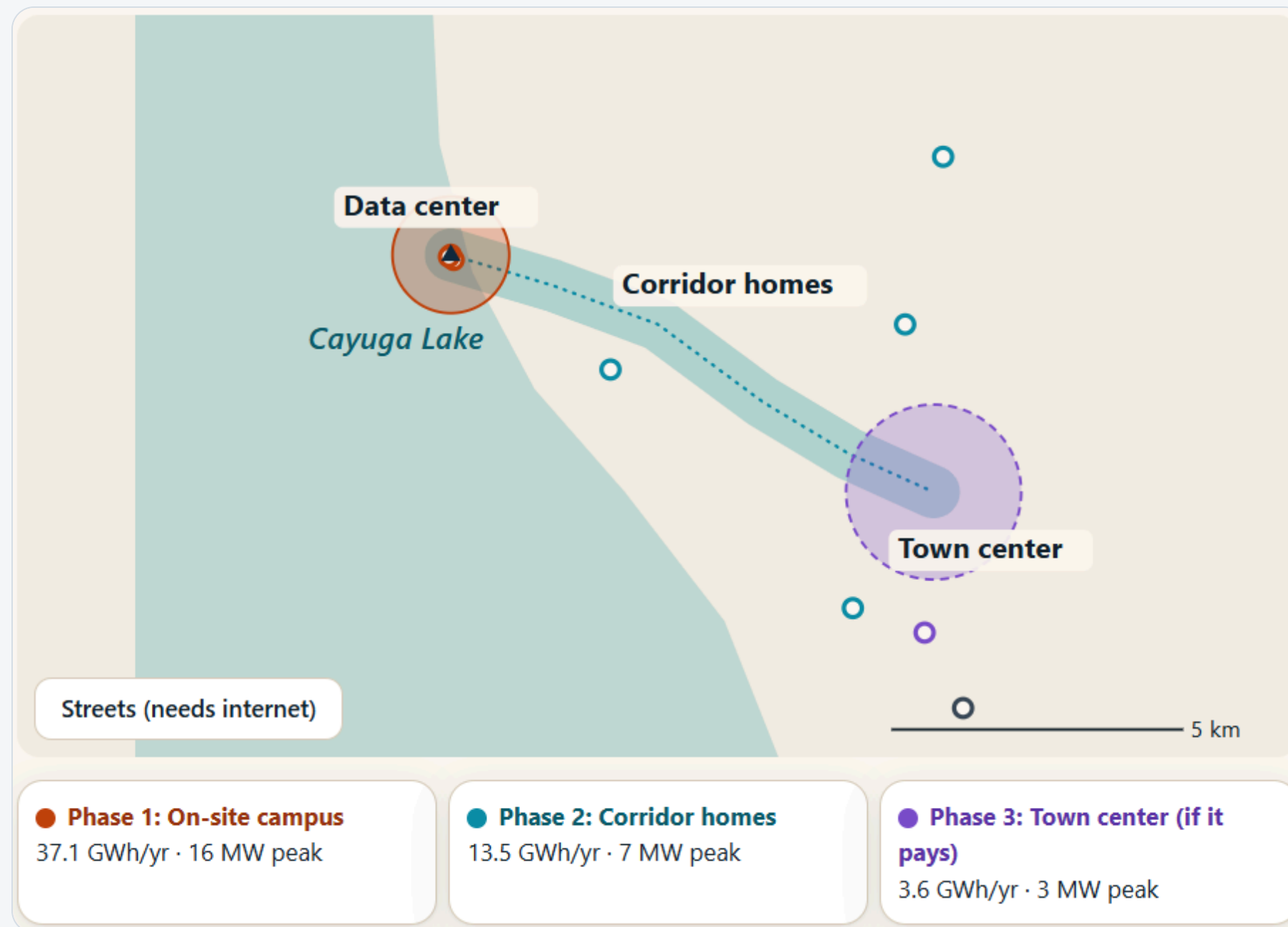
Community ownership

A thermal co-op owns the
network; the data center
supplies heat, not control

Public proof

An open dashboard reports heat
delivered, prices and CO2 every
month

The right tool at every density



1 · On-site campus

Greenhouse, fish, pool

\$41 / MWh Build

2 · Corridor

500 homes, ambient loop

\$286 / MWh Build with CBA funds

3 · Town center

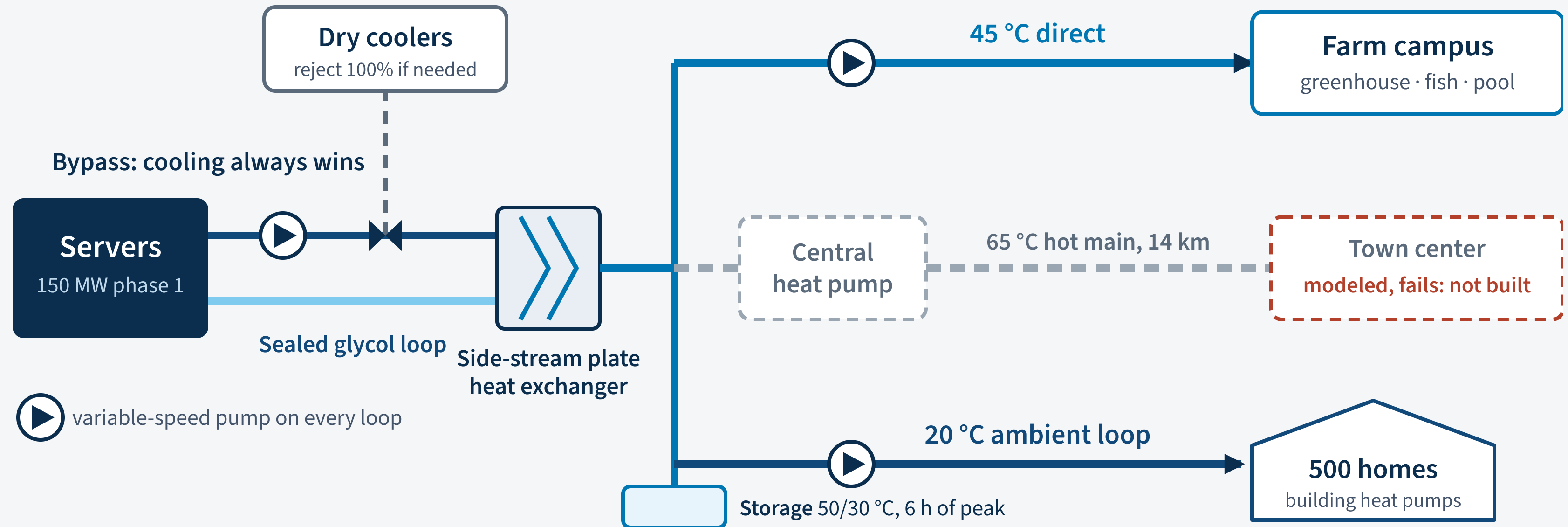
Hot main, 14 km

\$734 / MWh Fails: not built

Pipe goes only where heat density pays for it. Scattered homes get heat-pump rebates from the same community fund.

Levelized cost of heat at a 7% discount rate, 30 years. Map: Thermal Commons web app. Source: outputs/site2.json

How it works: every hour of the year



8,760-hour simulation on Ithaca typical-year weather, in an open Python model with tests. Backup boilers cover the peak.

$$\text{COP} = 0.5 \cdot T_{\text{sink}} / (T_{\text{sink}} - T_{\text{source}} + 6 \text{ K})$$

What it delivers, base case

\$735

a year off a propane bill

Typical home, 27 MWh a year. The tariff is set at 80% of propane, not at our cost. Vs oil: \$1,266.

50.6 GWh

heat delivered a year; 6.5% of the 778 GWh we can capture

\$106 / MWh

blended cost of heat vs propane \$136, oil \$156

11,408 t

CO2 avoided a year

THE HONEST PART

Pipe to scattered homes does not pay on its own. The community fund closes the gap.

~1.7%

of the build (an assumption-based estimate on a \$1.5B campus) funds the corridor gap and heat-pump rebates, through the Community Benefit Agreement

The on-site campus pays for itself.

A town-center main fails our own test, so we do not build it.

If the data center leaves, step-in rights and storage protect the co-op.

What Lansing gets

500

homes off propane and oil

4.6%

energy reuse factor, demand-limited:
6.5% of captured heat is used

126

local jobs

scenario estimate

5,500 t

food a year, 10 ha greenhouse

scenario estimate

1,500 t

fish a year, plus a year-round pool

scenario estimate

\$150k

a year for computer science in
Lansing's 3 public schools

proposed benefit-agreement term

Scored against seven regenerative domains: health, community, air, carbon, water, biodiversity and nutrients. We claim no lake water saved: the dry-cooler design is the developer's own.

Source: outputs/site2.json impact block (erf 0.0462); research/verification.md; school fund: docs/term-sheet.md 3.2 (proposal). Dashed cards are scenario estimates, not measurements.

Don't ban it. Set the terms.

1 · SIGN FIRST

**CBA and Heat
Supply Agreement
signed before site
approval**

2 · THE PRICE

1.7%

of the build. An assumption-
based estimate on a \$1.5B
campus.

3 · THE PAYOFF

\$735/yr

off a propane bill, per typical
home.

No one has signed yet. These are the terms we ask the Board to require.